RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

15 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 12:55 PM, Thursday 15 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 354 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Operating** · 82 cancelled

Riyadh halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, about 5,250 minutes at 1:00 PM; Dammam traffic moving after 9:40–10:51 AM halt

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh halted since 9:29 PM Sunday, about 5,250 minutes at 1:00 PM; NOTAM A3604/26 keeps it closed until 12:00 AM Sunday 18 Oct**.
- No Riyadh takeoff or landing in the last hour; 354 flights cancelled for Thursday (47% of scheduled).
- Coalition intercepted and destroyed a cruise missile over the Madinah region at 11:48 AM (CONFIRMED); no casualties reported.
- Dammam traffic moving after halt 9:40–10:51 AM; 82 flights cancelled today.
- Civil Defense alerts in Najran and Jizan ~10:21–10:27 AM cleared (CONFIRMED).

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (5246 min).

354	0/0	3
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

OPERATING

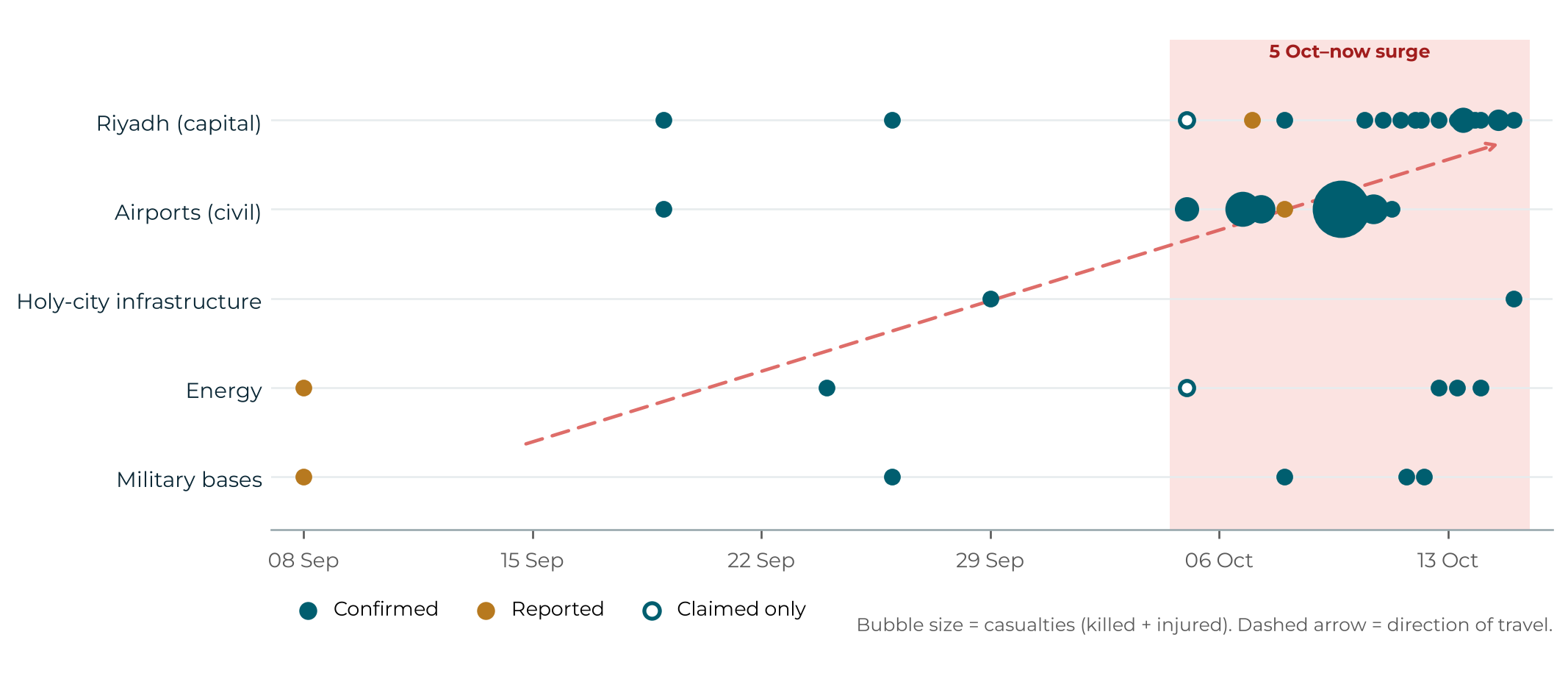
5 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour.

82	5/3	1
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday (5,190 min at 12:00 PM). Dammam last closed halt 9:40–10:51 AM; F3304 to Jeddah took off at 10:51 AM as that halt ended. Civil Defense Najran/Jizan alerts ~10:21–10:27 AM remain the latest official alert line (CONFIRMED). No new Coalition intercept statement since the Eastern Region drone kill early this morning.

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 15 OCT



39 sourced events since 8 September (33 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: cruise missile intercepted and destroyed over the Madinah region (15 Oct, Coalition spokesman / SPA; none reported (intercept)). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

2 Riyadh still halted; Civil Defense alerts in Najran and Jizan (~10:21–10:27 AM); Dammam moving after 9:40–10:51 AM halt

Checked at 12:54 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: cruise missile intercepted and destroyed over the Madinah region**
Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) · **11:48 AM** · published 11:48 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (Coalition spokesman, Arabic, translated; relayed by SPA 11:50 AM and Al Ekhbariya 11:53 AM); checked 12:54 PM

The Coalition spokesman said a cruise missile was intercepted and destroyed over the Madinah region. SPA and Al Ekhbariya relayed the statement. No casualties or debris damage reported so far.

CONFIRMED **King Khalid Intl Airport tells travellers to check flight status with their airline**
King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **12:26 PM** · published 12:23–12:26 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 12:54 PM

Replying to passengers, KKIA asked travellers to contact their airline to confirm flight status and get updates. No reopening announced.

CONFIRMED **Saudi MOFA: Riyadh | Deputy Minister for Public Diplomacy Dr. @Rayedkrimly received Kjersti Tromsdal, Ambassador of Norway to the Kingdom. They reviewed bilateral**
Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) · **12:43 PM** · published 12:43 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 12:54 PM

#Riyadh | Deputy Minister for Public Diplomacy Dr. @Rayedkrimly received Kjersti Tromsdal, Ambassador of Norway to the Kingdom. They reviewed bilateral relations and discussed shared interests.

CONFIRMED **Saudi MOFA: Riyadh | Deputy Minister for Public Diplomacy Dr. @Rayedkrimly received German Ambassador to the Kingdom, Michael Kindsgrab. They reviewed bilateral r**
Saudi MOFA (@KSAmofaEN) · **12:40 PM** · published 12:40 PM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 12:54 PM

#Riyadh | Deputy Minister for Public Diplomacy Dr. @Rayedkrimly received German Ambassador to the Kingdom, Michael Kindsgrab. They reviewed bilateral relations and discussed regional and international developments, as well as efforts to address them.

CONFIRMED **SPA: Fijian Conjoined Twins' Separation Surgery Begins in Riyadh Following Royal Directives**
SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **10:42 AM** · published 10:42 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 10:51 AM

Fijian Conjoined Twins' Separation Surgery Begins in Riyadh Following Royal Directives #SPAGOV

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense / Interior: filming or sharing missile and drone intercept or impact-site information is a legal liability**
Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **10:28 AM** · published 10:28 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 10:52 AM

Saudi Civil Defense, citing the Interior Ministry, warned that filming, publishing, or sharing information related to countering missiles and drones and their impact sites exposes people to legal liability.

CONFIRMED **Civil Defense: early-warning alerts in Najran then Jizan (~10:21–10:23 AM); danger cleared by ~10:26–10:27 AM**
Saudi Civil Defense (@SaudiDCD) · **10:21 AM** · published 10:21–10:27 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account); checked 10:52 AM

Saudi Civil Defense issued National Early Warning Platform alerts for Najran City at 10:21 AM and Jizan City at 10:23 AM, then posted that the danger had passed in Najran at 10:26 AM and in Jizan at 10:27 AM. No Coalition intercept statement or casualty report was posted with these alerts. Continue following Civil Defense instructions; avoid gathering and filming.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: separation surgery for Fiji twins Daisasia and Jessie Bailey begins in Riyadh**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **7:47 AM** · published 7:47 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 7:55 AM

Al Ekhbariya correspondent Mansour Al-Amir reported that separation surgery for twins Daisasia and Jessie Bailey from Fiji was about to begin in Riyadh, with 34 medical staff and an expected duration of about 15 hours. Unrelated to airport or attack developments.

CONFIRMED **SPA: thunderstorms and flood risk forecast for southwest and western regions**
SPA (@SPAregions) · **7:00 AM** · published 7:00 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 7:55 AM

SPA carried a National Center for Meteorology outlook for moderate to heavy thunderstorms with flash floods, hail and active winds over Jazan, Asir, Al-Baha and Makkah, and lighter to moderate rain over Medina, Hail, Tabuk, Al-Jouf, the Northern Borders and the Eastern Region. No airport closure linked to weather in the bulletin.

CONFIRMED **SPA: oil prices fall as investors assess supply outlook**
SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **6:51 AM** · published 6:51 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (SPA English); checked 7:55 AM

SPA English reported that oil prices fell as investors assessed the supply outlook. No new official link in the post to Red Sea or Hormuz transit disruption.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Coalition intercepted and destroyed a drone over the Eastern Region**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:59 AM** · published 5:59 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya relayed the coalition statement that a drone was intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region. No casualties reported in the coalition line.

CONFIRMED **Saudi embassy in Bahrain helping citizens with disrupted flights get home, including by road**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:15 AM** · published 5:15 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported ongoing efforts by the Saudi embassy in Bahrain to help Saudi citizens whose flights were affected return home, including arranging land transport.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region**
SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **4:13 AM** · published 4:13 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (Coalition spokesman, Arabic; SPA English 4:43 AM); checked 6:50 AM

The Coalition spokesman said a drone (UAV) was intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region; first posted in Arabic at 4:13 AM by the Coalition spokesman and SPA, English release from SPA at 4:43 AM. No casualties or debris damage reported so far.

CONFIRMED **Yemeni armed forces say about 1,250 Houthi fighters neutralised and more than 460 militia vehicles destroyed**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **2:35 AM** · published 2:35 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported that Yemen's armed forces said about 1,250 Houthi fighters had been neutralised and more than 460 militia military vehicles destroyed; the figures are the Yemeni forces' own and were not independently verified. No new attack, interception, Civil Defense alert or airport statement was posted by official Saudi accounts between 2:00 and 3:00 AM.

CONFIRMED **Islamic Affairs Minister praises the armed forces' sacrifices in protecting the Kingdom**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **1:45 AM** · published 1:45 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 6:50 AM

Minister of Islamic Affairs Sheikh Dr. Abdullatif Al-Sheikh said the Kingdom will remain a nation of monotheism and pure creed, and that it values the great sacrifices of the armed forces in protecting the homeland. No new attack, interception or airport statement was posted by official Saudi accounts between 1:00 and 2:00 AM.

CONFIRMED **Saudi UN envoy in Geneva: Kingdom condemns repeated Houthi attacks and affirms its right to protect its sovereignty**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **12:34 AM** · published 12:34 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 12:58 AM

Abdulmohsen bin Khuthaila, the Kingdom's permanent representative to the UN in Geneva, said Saudi Arabia condemns the Houthi terrorist militia's repeated attacks on its territory and affirms its right to protect its sovereignty and the security of citizens and residents under international law.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya correspondent in Yemen: 'Dawn of Yemen' operation escalating on Taiz, Marib and Lahj fronts**
Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **12:25 AM** · published 12:25 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); checked 12:58 AM

Saudi state broadcaster Al Ekhbariya's Yemen correspondent reported the 'Dawn of Yemen' operation is escalating quickly, with 24 hours of fighting on the northern and western fronts of Taiz city. He said the Houthi militia fired more than 1,000 mortar rounds at Jabal Han in 24 hours without a breakthrough. Battlefield claims are not independently verified.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport (KKIA) tells passengers to check flight status with their airline**
King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **12:24 AM** · published 12:24 AM AST Thu 15 Oct (official account reply, Arabic, translated); checked 12:58 AM

Replying to a passenger, King Khalid International Airport said that for flight status or any updates, travellers should contact their airline, as the carrier is responsible for the flight. No reopening time was given.

CONFIRMED **SPA: Bahrain condemns Houthi attacks on the Kingdom and urges decisive Security Council measures**
SPA (@Spa_Eng, @SPAregions) · **11:56 PM Wed** · published 11:56 PM AST Wed 14 Oct (SPA English; Arabic 10:20 PM); checked 12:58 AM

The Saudi Press Agency reported that Bahrain strongly condemned the Houthi terrorist militia's attacks on Saudi Arabia and urged the UN Security Council to take decisive measures. It adds to the string of foreign condemnations carried by SPA since the airport strikes.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

3 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (5246 min).

354	4:11 AM	—	0	3
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
165 departures + 189 arrivals, 47% of 750 scheduled.	SV1523 to Tabuk, 1964 min before 12:55 PM.	None on the board.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Dammam, Qassim.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 12:55 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 350 at 12:56 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**165**	**189**	**354**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**161 (43%)**	**189 (51%)**	**350**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**1 (0%)**	**1 (0%)**	**2**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**66 (99%)**	**55 (98%)**	**121**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**0 min**	**0 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**0 of 186**	**0 of 155**	**0 of 341**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**3**	**3**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**14**	**26**	**40**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**236**	**217**	**453**	FR24 stats panel

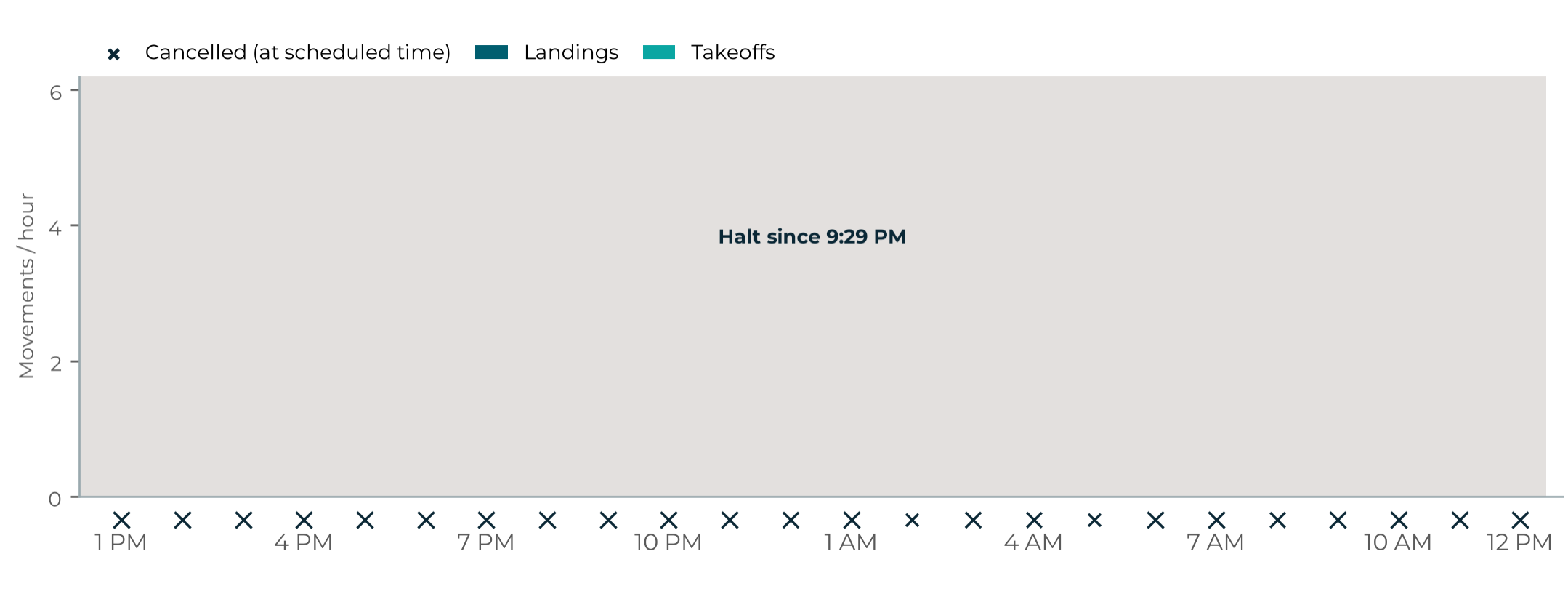
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	**217**
Riyadh Air	**22**
flynas	**18**
Qatar Airways	**15**
flyadeal	**11**

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	**54**
Madinah	**31**
Dubai	**22**
Dammam	**19**
Doha	**17**

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



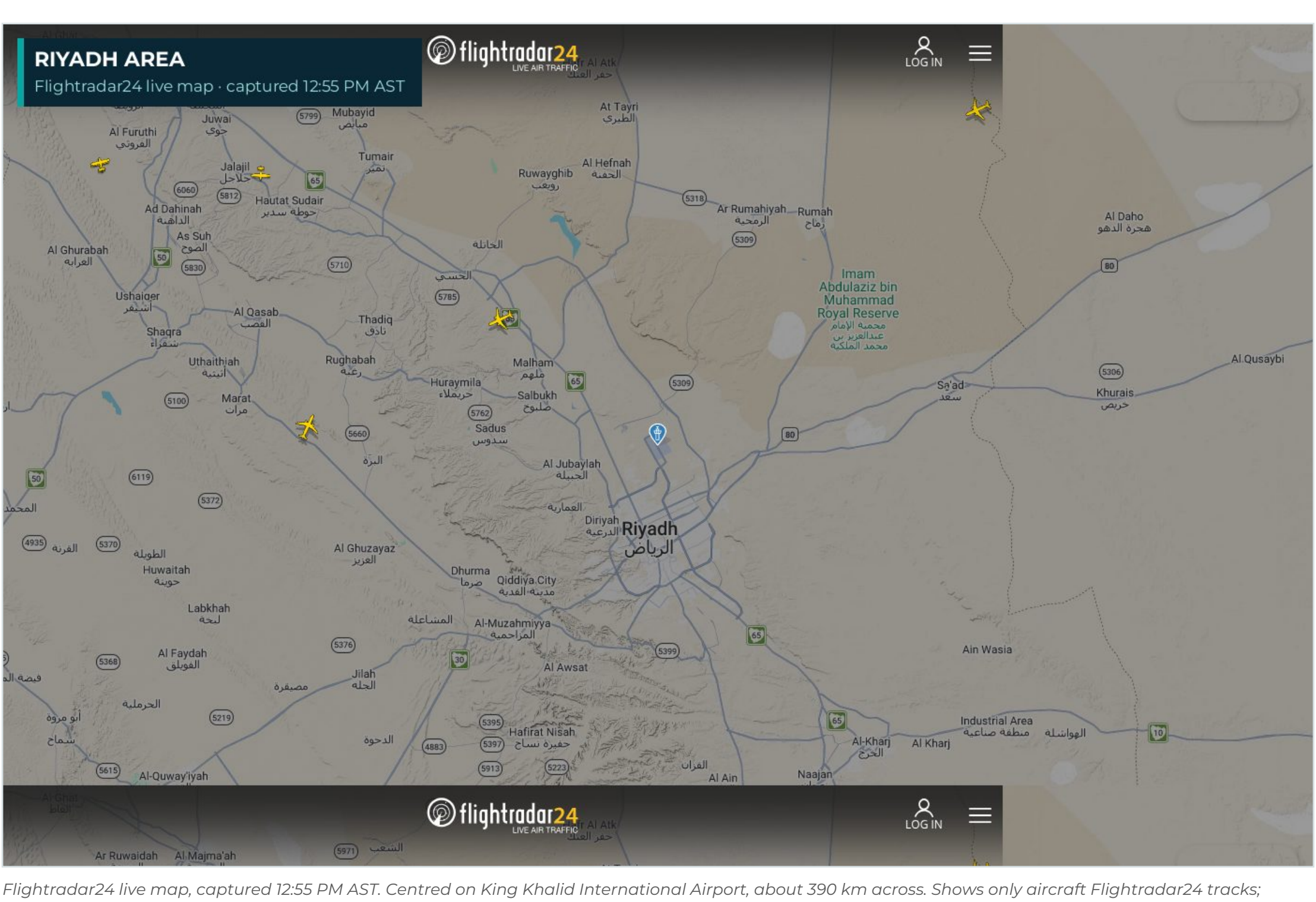
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (0) at RUH per hour from 1:00 PM Wednesday to 12:55 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movement in it was SV1523 to Tabuk at 4:11 AM Wednesday. Dammam's 9:40–10:51 AM halt closed when F3304 departed for Jeddah.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	5246 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 12:55 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

4 Dammam airport: operating. 5 takeoffs and 3 landings in the last hour.

82	12:38 PM	12:48 PM	5	1
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
41 departures + 41 arrivals, 29% of 286 scheduled.	IA662 to Najaf, 18 min before 12:55 PM.	XY753 from AlUla, 7 min before 12:55 PM.	3 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Madinah.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 12:55 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 82 at 12:56 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**41**	**41**	**82**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**41 (29%)**	**41 (28%)**	**82**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**14 (10%)**	**10 (7%)**	**24**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**10 (42%)**	**13 (57%)**	**23**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**12 min**	**6 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**24 of 60**	**23 of 56**	**47 of 116**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**1**	**1**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**16**	**14**	**30**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**45**	**43**	**88**	FR24 stats panel

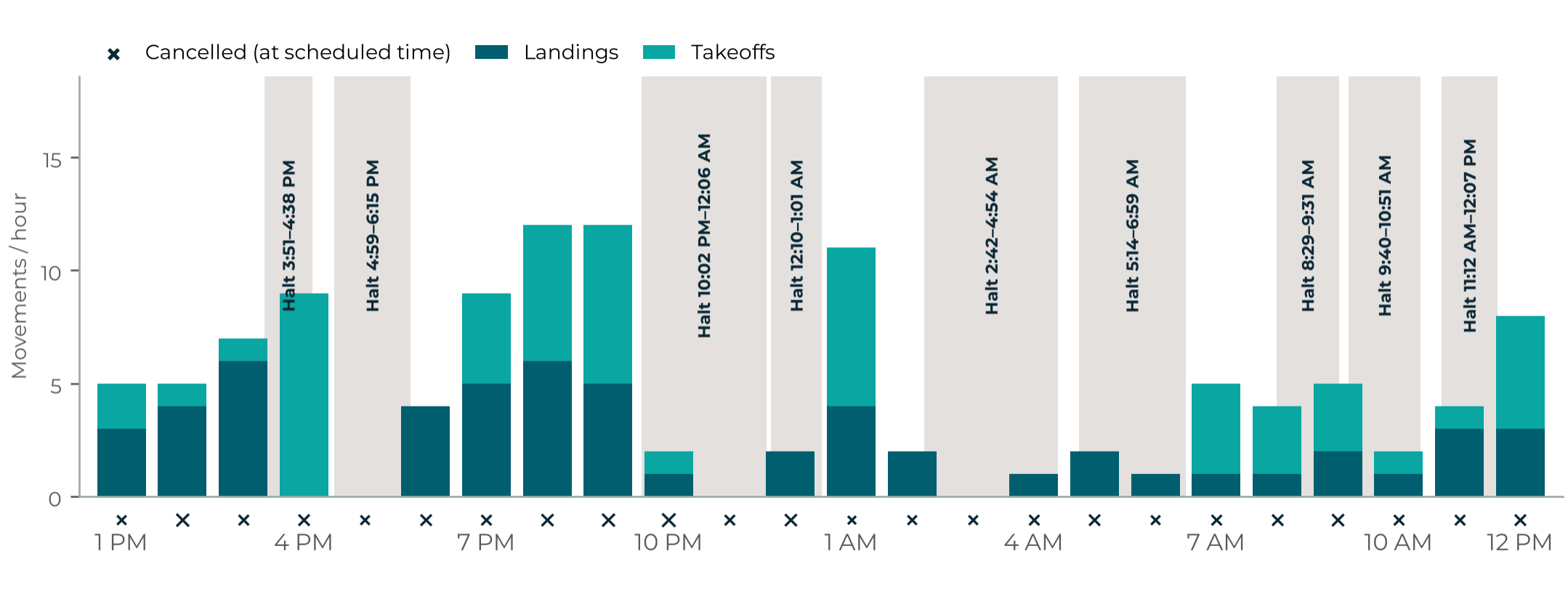
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	**21**
Emirates	**8**
Etihad Airways	**8**
flydubai	**8**
Egyptair	**6**

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Riyadh	**19**
Dubai	**16**
Jeddah	**9**
Abu Dhabi	**8**
Cairo	**6**

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (55) and landings (57) at DMM per hour from 1:00 PM Wednesday to 12:55 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

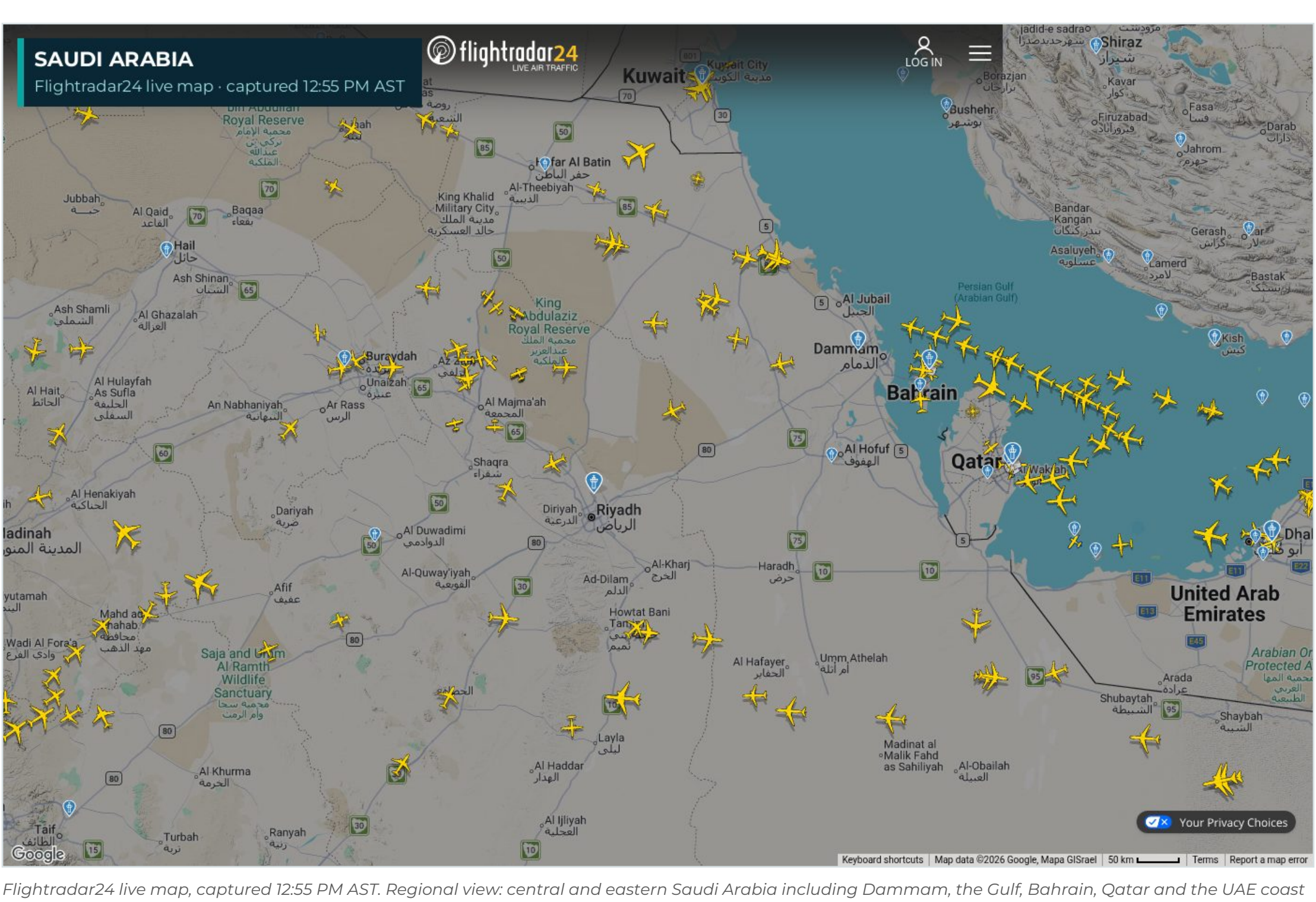
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 11:12 AM–12:07 PM	55 min
Halt 9:40–10:51 AM	71 min
Halt 8:29–9:31 AM	62 min
Halt 5:14–6:59 AM	105 min
Halt 2:42–4:54 AM	132 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (12:54 PM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



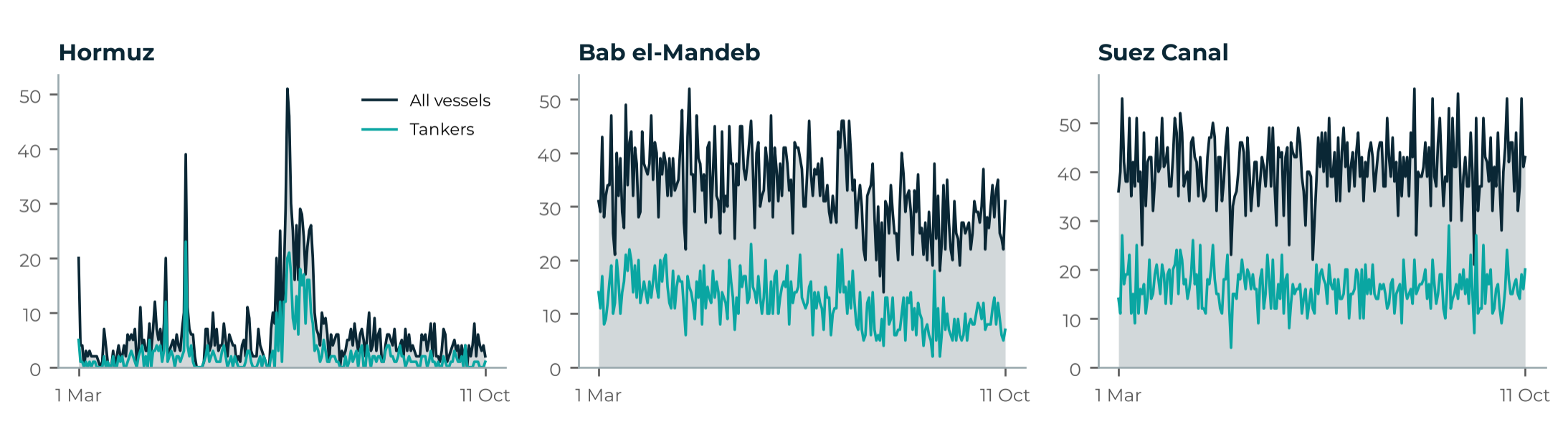
Flightradar24 live map, captured 12:55 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

5 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

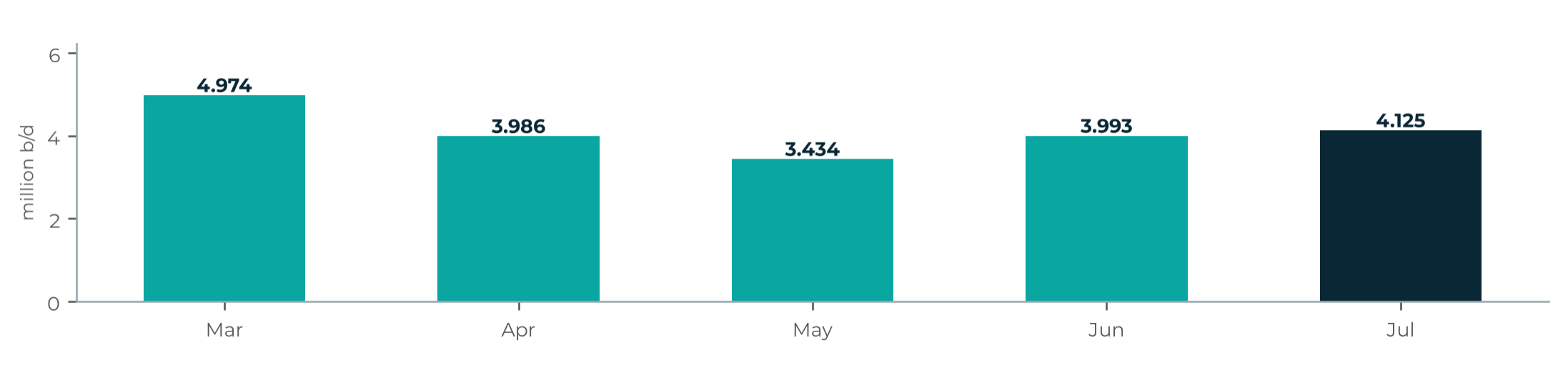
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 11 Oct	**2**	1	1	4.1 (2.7)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 11 Oct	**31**	7	24	28.3 (29.6)
Suez Canal	Sun 11 Oct	**43**	20	23	41.7 (43.1)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 12:56 PM, Thu 15 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

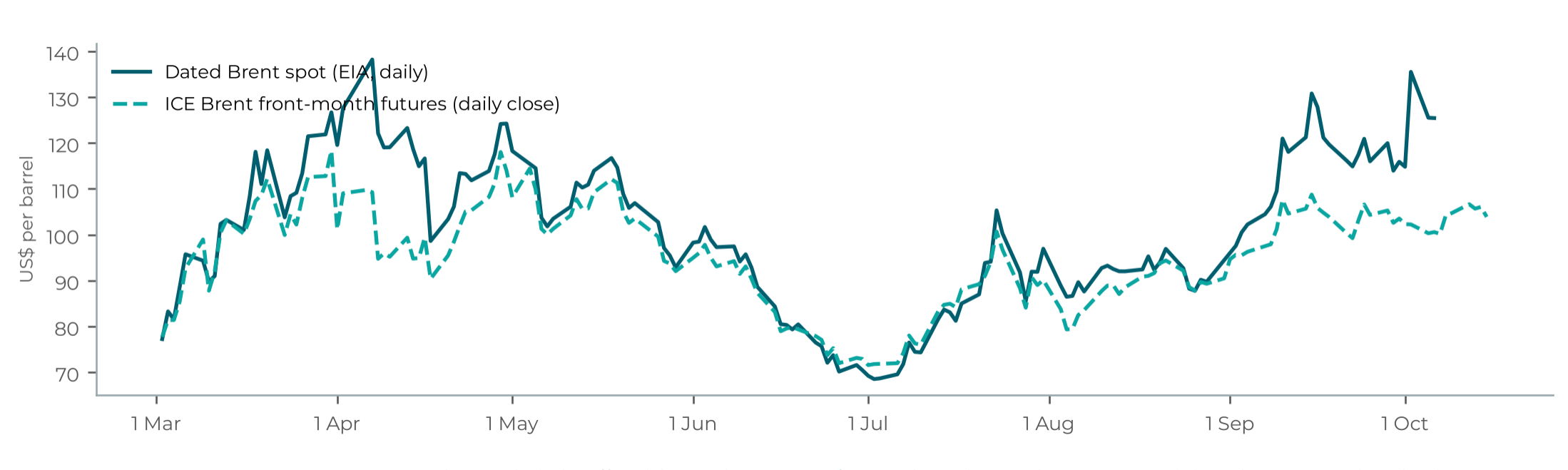


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$103.90	$125.44	+23%	+62%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 12:46 PM, Thu 15 Oct AST (-2.0% on day). Near real time.	Tue 6 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $102.24 on Fri 4 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

6 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 12:55 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
12:55 PM, Thu 15 Oct	12:55 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Operating**	Open sources · not official	2:00 PM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 2:00 PM